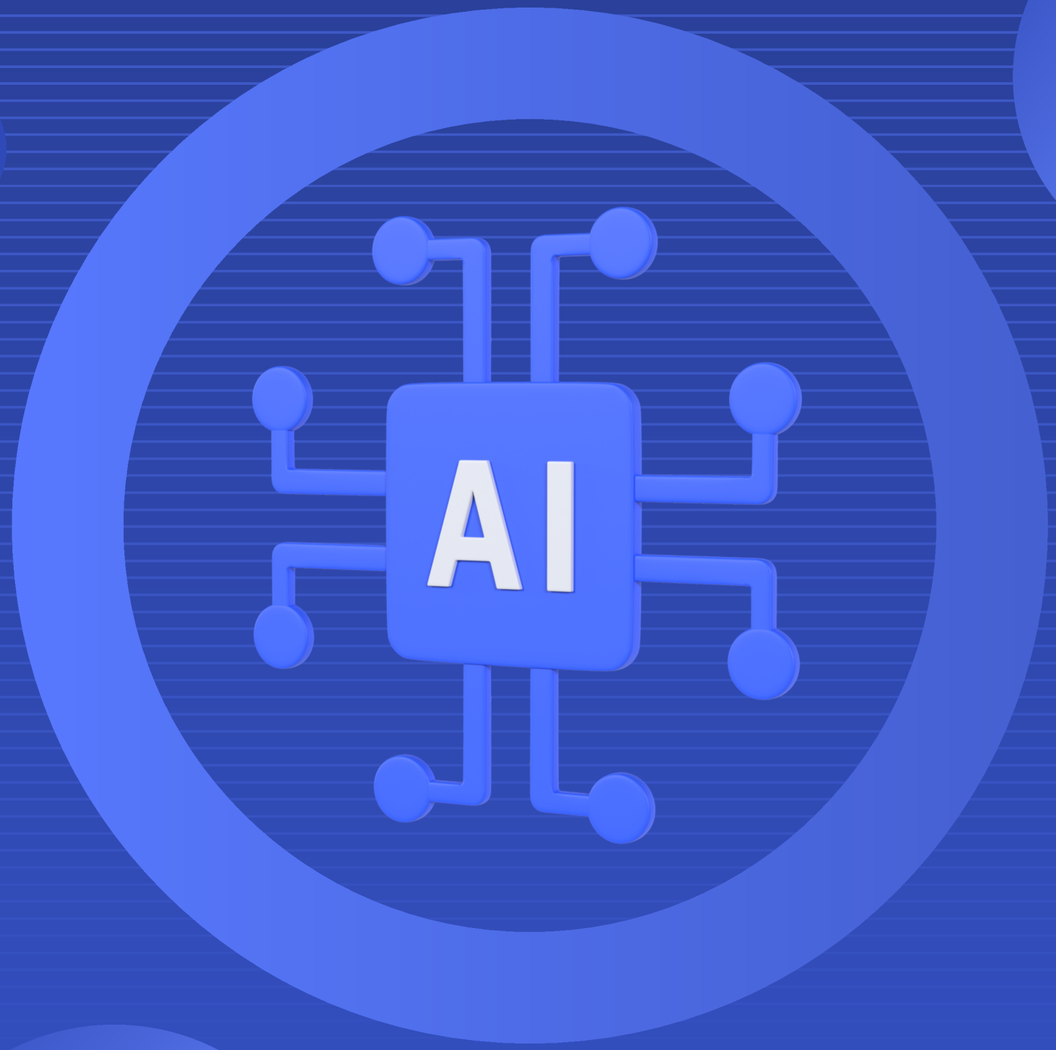
UWA

CYBER SECURITY

How to spot phishing and scam messages



Presented by Amsyar

What is phishing?

Phishing is a type of cyberattack where someone tries to trick you into giving away sensitive information.

They may try to steal:

- passwords
- banking details
- personal information
- one-time passwords (OTP)
- account access

What is a scam message?

Its goal is usually to make you:

- click a malicious link
- send money
- share personal information
- trust a fake identity
- download something harmful

Scam messages often pretend to be from:

- banks
- delivery companies
- government agencies
- online stores
- friends or family

Common signs of phishing

Look out for these warning signs:

- urgent language
- “Act now” / “Your account will be locked”
- suspicious links
- strange sender address
- unexpected requests
- poor grammar or unusual wording
- requests for passwords or OTP codes
- messages that create fear or panic

If you think a message is fake

If you suspect phishing:

1. Do not click anything
2. Do not reply
3. Check the sender and link
4. Contact the real organisation directly
5. Delete or report the message
6. Change your password if you interacted with it
7. Monitor your account for unusual activity

Why this matters

Phishing can lead to:

- stolen accounts
- financial loss
- identity theft
- leaked personal data
- emotional stress
- compromise of other linked accounts

Even smart people can be targeted.

Modern scam messages can look very convincing.

Cybersecurity awareness helps reduce this risk.

Key takeaway

Before trusting a message, always ask:

- Who sent this?
- Why are they creating urgency?
- Does the link look real?
- Are they asking for sensitive information?
- Can I verify this another way?

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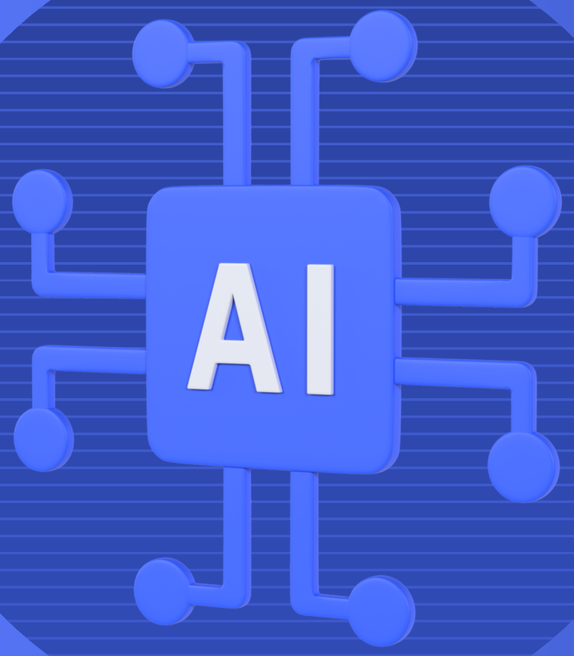
FINAL MESSAGE

Stop. Check. Verify



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